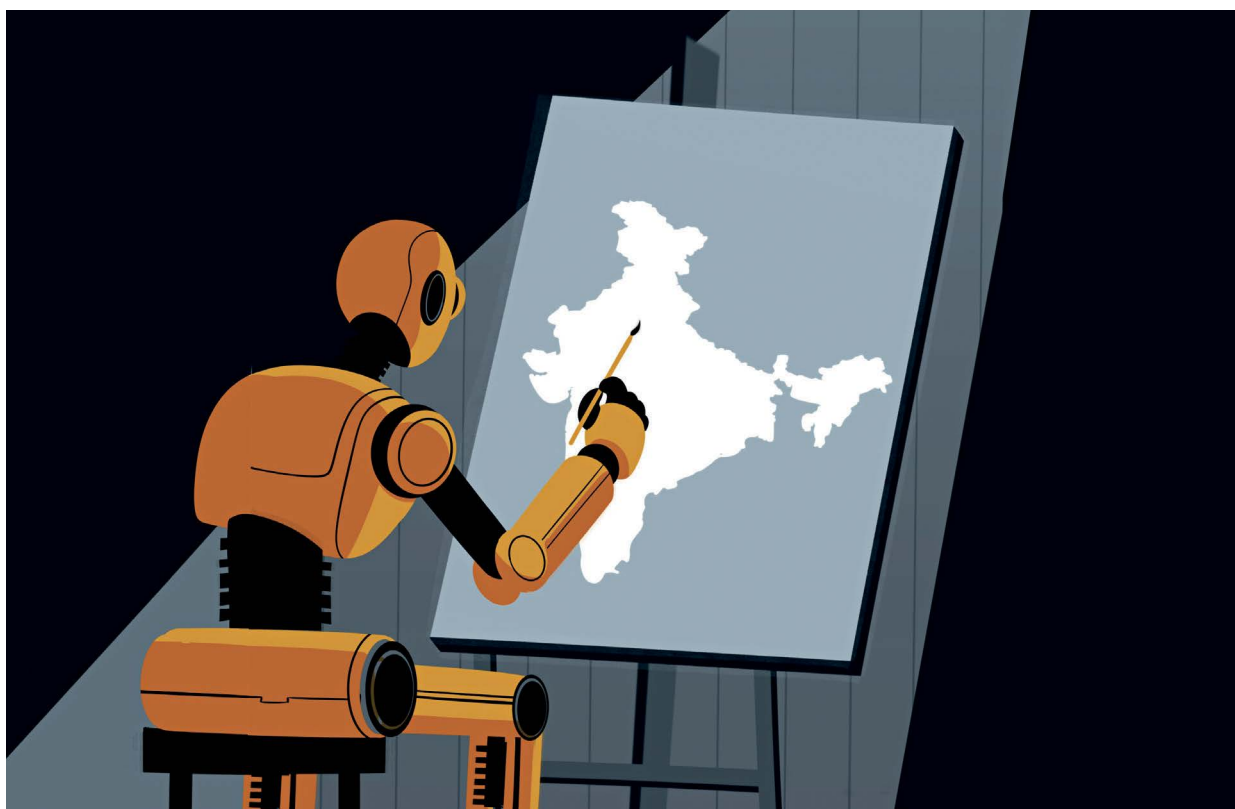




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ILLUSTRATION BY **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

to build and innovate, ensuring India's capacity to advance across successive generations of AI systems. We need to seed an ecosystem where Indian developers, researchers, and startups can build a wide spectrum of AI use-cases and products rooted in local needs and global potential. Developing India's AI leadership also requires investing in education that emphasises hands-on GenAI learning, equipping talent with the skills needed to lead and innovate across the ecosystem. Equally important is the infrastructure that underpins this ambition; domestic investments in compute and storage capacity will anchor model development within India's borders, ensuring

resilience and security at scale.

India's strategy must focus on seeding an ecosystem that makes AI accessible and affordable by driving down inference costs through optimised architectures. We need developer-friendly APIs that will empower rapid fine-tuning and personalisation, unlocking flexibility and speed for local innovators. At the same time, embracing edge computing will bring AI applications closer to users, enabling low-latency solutions that reach every corner of the country.

GenAI marks the most significant technological shift in decades, with the potential to influence every aspect of our economy, governance, and daily

lives. For India, the stakes are clear. We need foundational AI built on our data, infrastructure, and talent. The case for a Sovereign AI ecosystem is not about isolation. It is about control, resilience, and relevance on the global stage. This means investing in domestic computing, empowering our developer community, and building systems that work for India's needs.

India has done this before. We have already demonstrated that we can deliver world-class digital infrastructure at a population scale. Now, that same population-scale ambition must drive India's AI journey. **BT**

Views are personal